

Abattoir regulations (smoke corpus)

This compilation of abattoir regulations governs the slaughter of livestock, the inspection of meat, and the licensing of abattoir premises. Every operator must hold a valid licence before slaughter activities begin, and the central register records every premises approval.

Abattoir licensing

Abattoir licensing requires an annual renewal. The licensing desk processes each licence application within ten working days, and an abattoir licence may be suspended where hygiene findings show repeated breaches of the licensing conditions.

Meat inspection

Meat inspection precedes each slaughter day. Veterinary inspection of meat covers ante-mortem and post-mortem examination, and the inspection record is entered in the central register before inspectors leave the premises.

Slaughter fees

Slaughter fees are payable on invoice within thirty days. The fee schedule lists per-head slaughter fees for cattle, sheep and goats, and overdue fees become penalties enforceable under the regulations.

Animal welfare

Animal welfare at the slaughterhouse is protected by law: handling of livestock must avoid unnecessary pain, and welfare officers may inspect stunning equipment at any time without prior notice.

Hygiene compliance

Hygiene compliance covers the washdown of kill floors, chilled storage temperatures, and the personal hygiene of staff. Compliance findings are recorded by inspectors during each hygiene audit of the abattoir.

Transport of livestock

Livestock transport vehicles must be cleaned between journeys. Transport pens at the abattoir provide water, and transport duration limits protect animal welfare during long journeys to the slaughterhouse.

Waste handling

Waste handling at the slaughterhouse separates specified risk material. Rendering plants collect the waste, and handling records trace every waste consignment leaving the abattoir site.

Export certification

Export certification of meat is issued after inspection. Each export consignment receives a health certificate, and certification numbers are logged for traceability of exported meat to the export market.